



Module 11: Social Media Strategy for a Business

You've learned about audiences, platforms, content, Instagram, SEO, growth, analytics, and paid advertising. Now it's time to put everything together into one cohesive plan. A social media strategy answers one simple question: **"What should this business do on social media, for whom, why — and how will we measure success?"**

MODULE 11

SOCIAL MEDIA MARKETING

What Is a Social Media Strategy?

A social media strategy is a **structured plan** that moves a business beyond random posting and gives it a clear, measurable direction. It answers every critical "who, what, where, when, and why" question before a single post goes live.

✗ A Content Plan

"We will post 4 Reels every week."

01

Who to Reach

Define your target audience clearly.

03

What Content

Plan content pillars and formats.

✓ A Social Media Strategy

"We will target college students and young professionals in Mumbai, use Instagram as our primary platform, create relatable and educational food content, publish 4 Reels and 3 Stories per week, engage with local audiences, and measure reach, profile visits, engagement, and enquiries."

02

Which Platforms

Choose based on audience behavior.

04

How to Measure

Define KPIs tied to business goals.

Start With the Business Goal

Before deciding what to post, understand what the business actually wants to achieve.

Different goals require completely different strategies. A social media marketer should never start with content ideas before understanding the business objective.

New Café

Primary Goal: Build local awareness and bring people through the door.

Coaching Institute

Primary Goal: Generate student enquiries and course sign-ups.

E-Commerce Brand

Primary Goal: Drive online product sales and repeat purchases.

 Always ask: "What does the business need to achieve?" — before asking "What should we post?"



Our Example: The Brew Corner, Mumbai

Throughout this module, we'll build a complete strategy for an imaginary café to illustrate every concept in practice. Let's meet the business.

Business Profile

Name: The Brew Corner

Location: Mumbai

Offering: Coffee, desserts, snacks and quick meals

Target: Young people, college students, working professionals and local residents

Business Goal: Increase local awareness, attract customers and generate more visits

Audience Persona: Riya

Age: 22 | **Location:** Mumbai

Lifestyle: College student

Interests: Cafés, food, Instagram, photography, hanging out with friends

Need: Affordable and aesthetic places to meet friends and create content

Social Media Behaviour: Watches Reels, saves café recommendations, shares food content with friends.

Steps 1 & 2 — Audience & Platforms

Step 1 – Define the Target Audience

For The Brew Corner, focus on people who can **realistically visit** the location — not everyone in India.

- College students and young professionals
- Ages 18–35, coffee and dessert lovers
- People looking for cafés to meet friends or work/study
- Local residents and people who work nearby
- People interested in food, cafés and lifestyle content

Step 2 – Choose the Right Platforms

Not every business needs to be on every platform. Choose based on audience and objective.

Instagram — Primary

Highly visual, strong Reels discovery, ideal for younger audiences and local food content.

Facebook — Secondary

Useful for local communities, older segments, event promotions and local offers.

Google Business Profile

Critical for local discovery. Maintain accurate address, hours, photos, reviews and contact details.

Step 3 — Content Pillars

Content pillars are the **main recurring themes** a business consistently creates content around. Instead of scrambling for new ideas daily, the café works within a structured, purposeful framework.



Food & Products

Coffee, desserts, pasta, sandwiches, new menu items and bestsellers.



Café Experience

Ambience, seating, interior, music, staff and customer experience.



Relatable / Entertainment

POV memes, trending formats and humorous café moments that make the brand feel human.



Educational / Value

Coffee facts, how to choose your drink, food pairing ideas and café etiquette tips.



Promotional

Weekend combos, new launches, student offers, seasonal menus and special events.

Steps 4 & 5 — Frequency & Reel Ideas

Step 4 – Posting Frequency

Posting frequency must be **realistic and sustainable**. Quality and consistency matter more than volume.

Instagram

4 Reels/week · 2 static or carousel posts/week ·
Stories almost daily

Facebook

3 posts per week, focused
on local promotions and
community updates



Posting 20 low-quality pieces one week and disappearing for three weeks is NOT a strategy. Sustainability wins.

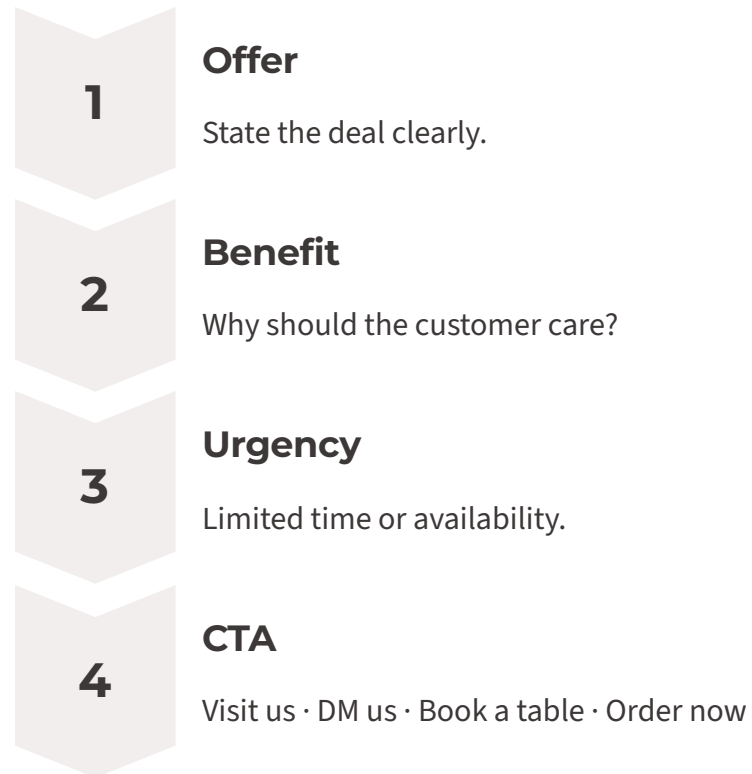
Step 5 – Reel Ideas for The Brew Corner

- **Food:** "POV: Your coffee order just arrived." · "Watch us make our signature cold coffee."
- **Relatable:** "When your friend says 'I'm not hungry' and then eats your fries." · "Types of people at a café."
- **Experience:** "A day at The Brew Corner." · "What our café looks like during golden hour."
- **Educational:** "Latte vs Cappuccino — What's the difference?" · "Which coffee should you order if you don't like bitter coffee?"
- **Promotional:** "Weekend special is here." · "Student combo available this week."

Steps 6, 7 & 8 — Promotion, Engagement & Local Strategy

Step 6 – Promotional Content Structure

Every promotional post should follow a clear formula:



Step 7 – Engagement Strategy

Posting is only half the job. Actively interact with the audience to build community.

- Reply to comments and DMs promptly
- Repost customer Stories and encourage tagging
- Run polls — "Pick your weekend drink: Cold Coffee or Matcha?"
- Engage with local food creators, college communities and nearby businesses

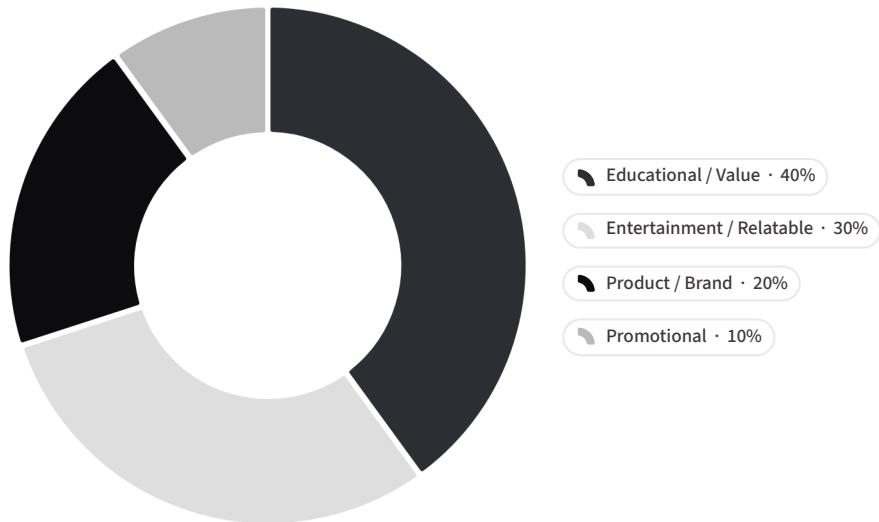
Step 8 – Local Content Strategy

Use **location-based references** in captions, Reels and profile: Mumbai café culture, nearby landmarks, local events, college areas and weekend plans.
Example: *"Looking for a cosy café in Mumbai for your weekend plans?"*

Steps 9 & 10 — Content Mix & KPIs

Step 9 – Monthly Content Mix

A balanced content strategy doesn't turn your account into an advertisement. Use this as a starting guide — not a rigid formula.



Step 10 – Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

KPIs connect social media activity to **real business outcomes**. Track based on your primary goal.



Awareness KPIs

Reach · Impressions · Video views ·
Follower growth



Engagement KPIs

Likes · Comments · Shares · Saves ·
Story replies



Business KPIs

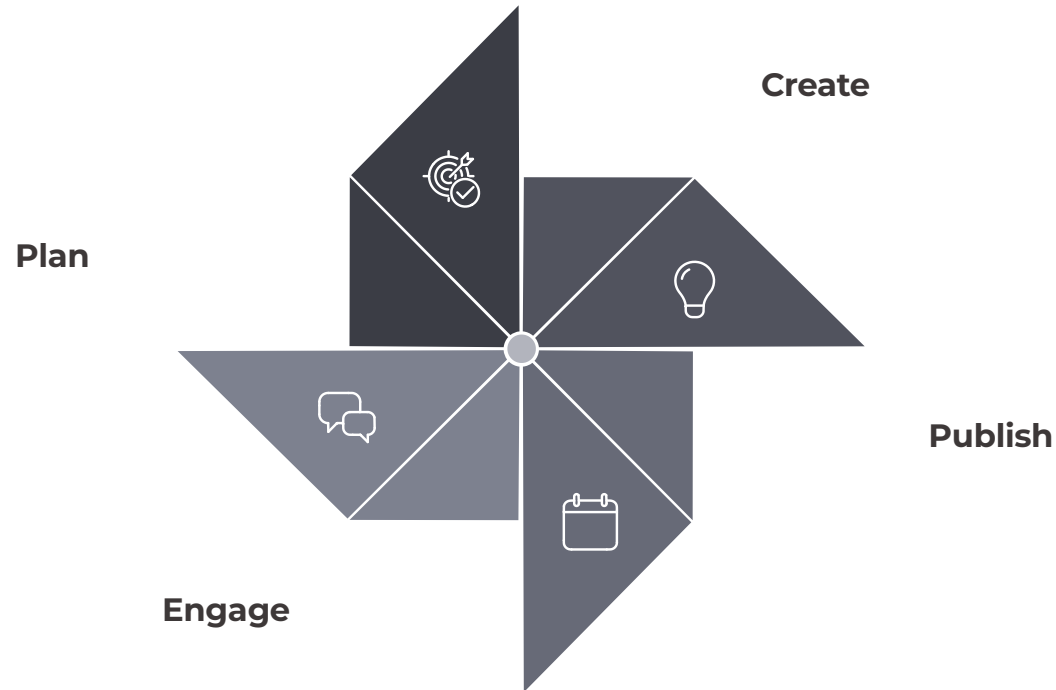
DMs · WhatsApp enquiries · Table bookings · Direction requests · Coupon usage ·
Orders



Remember: Café B with 8,000 followers and 300 enquiries/month outperforms Café A with 50,000 followers and 100 enquiries. Followers ≠ Business Success.

The Complete Strategy Framework

Use this 12-step framework for any business — real or imaginary. Every great social media strategy follows this cycle.



Business & Goal

What does it sell? What does it want to achieve?

Audience & Platforms

Who are the ideal customers? Where do they spend time?

Pillars & Frequency

What topics will be covered? How often can quality content be published?

Engagement & KPIs

How will the business interact with its community and measure real outcomes?

Student Practical Assignment

Now it's your turn. Choose any imaginary or local business — a café, salon, gym, clothing store, dental clinic, coaching institute, restaurant, bakery, makeup artist or real estate company — and build a **one-month social media strategy** using this template.

Strategy Template

- ☐ Business Name & Type
- ☐ Location
- ☐ Business Goal
- ☐ Target Audience
- ☐ Primary & Secondary Platform
- ☐ Content Pillars 1–4
- ☐ Posting Frequency
- ☐ 3 Reel Ideas
- ☐ Promotional Content Idea
- ☐ Engagement Strategy
- ☐ Primary CTA
- ☐ KPIs & How You'll Measure Success

Beginner Strategy Challenge

Imagine you've been hired as the social media manager for a Mumbai café. The owner says: *"I want more people to know about my café and more customers from Instagram."*

Work through these strategic questions:

- **Who should we target?**

College students, young professionals, local residents and food lovers.

- **Which platform?**

Instagram — visual, local discovery, ideal for the audience.

- **How will we measure success?**

Reach, engagement, profile activity, enquiries and bookings.

 **A great social media manager's first question is always:** "What are we trying to achieve?" — not "What should we post today?"